“Clean Desk” Confidential Information and Sensitive Materials

WyIT.2009

Policy Owner	Department of Enterprise Services, Data Privacy
Policy Contact	Pat Potter, Deputy Chief Data Officer
Policy Approver	Wyoming Data Governance Committee (WDGC)
Effective Date	September 12, 2025
Next Review Date	April 1, 2027
Policy Version	2026-09.1

Scope:

This policy establishes workspace-level document security requirements that operate within the broader framework of WyIT 3013, Physical and Environmental Protection.

Specifically, this policy defines minimum requirements for agencies to maintain a "clean desk" – where internal, confidential, and sensitive information, regardless of format, structure, or formal asset designation, is stored away and out of sight when not in use or when the workspace is vacant.

This policy addresses the following key areas:

- Physical security controls for confidential and sensitive documents in individual workspaces;
- Proper storage, handling, and disposal procedures for non-electronic sensitive materials;
- Integration with electronic information security requirements under WyIT 3001, General Security - Acceptable Use;
- Special considerations for highly secured areas handling criminal justice or health data;
- Clear desk protocols to prevent unauthorized visual access to sensitive information;
- Coordination with facility-level physical security measures under WyIT 3013, Physical and Environmental Protection.

This policy serves as the state baseline. Agencies may implement more restrictive policies to meet applicable state and federal regulations or agency-specific requirements, provided they do not deviate substantially from this policy. In lieu of agency-specific policies, this policy shall serve as the governing standard.

Authority

This policy is promulgated under the authority of Wyoming State Statute 9-2-2906 and its subsections, the Department of Enterprise Technology Services is required to adopt and enforce information

technology standards, and promote efficient use of information technology throughout state government.

Specifically, this policy is further promulgated under the authority of the below listed Wyoming State Statute subsections.

- Implements and maintains an information technology governance program for state agencies (W.S 9-2-2906,(b), (ii));
- Establishes and enforces data security and privacy policies and standards for the state data infrastructure Establishes review criteria for the agencies information technology projects, procurements and purchases. (W.S 9-2-2906,(b), (iii)); and

Adopts information technology policies and standards and ensures agency compliance with those policies and standards (W.S. 9-2-2906,(b), (vi)).

Audience

This policy applies to all Executive Branch agencies, boards, and commissions staff (collectively referred to as "agencies"). This policy is also applicable to consultants, affiliates, third party vendors and temporary employees that use or store state data.

Definitions

Key Definitions, Acronyms, and Terms

Policy Statements:

1. **POLICY PRECEDENCE AND AGENCY IMPLEMENTATION**

1.1. The agency may create agency-specific policies that meet the outlined scope, purpose, and requirements as stated in this policy. In lieu of agency-specific policies that meet the outlined scope, purpose, and requirements as stated in this policy, this policy shall be the governing policy.
[1], [2], [3]

1.2. Agencies may implement supplemental policies to augment this governing policy as needed. This policy does not supersede any State or Federal regulation and does not override, waive, or provide exemption from the requirements of the Wyoming Public Records Act.
[1], [2], [3]

1.3. This policy supplements WyIT 3013, Physical and Environmental Protection with specific requirements for workspace document security. Where conflicts arise, this policy takes precedence for facility-level security requirements.
[3], [2], [3], [4]

2. **REQUIREMENTS**

Employees are responsible for understanding and following the policy and all related procedures.

[2]

3. **PHYSICAL CONFIDENTIAL AND SENSITIVE INFORMATION**

3.1. Highly Secured Areas with stringent access controls, such as those inspected and authorized by federal agencies for handling sensitive information, regardless of format, structure, or formal asset designation, like criminal or health data, may be exempted from this policy.

Such as:

3.1.1. Restricted access is limited to personnel with appropriate security clearance.

3.1.2. Escort protocols for any unauthorized personnel when access is required

3.1.3. Regular security audits to ensure compliance with federal standards

[2] , [5], [6]

4. **NON-ELECTRONIC CONFIDENTIAL AND SENSITIVE INFORMATION**

All non-electronic sensitive and confidential information must be handled as follows:

4.1. When working in a private office, if left unattended or at the end of the workday, non-electronic confidential and sensitive information shall be secured behind the locked door of the office.

[2], [3]

4.2. When working in an open office environment, if left unattended for short periods, non-electronic confidential and sensitive information must be stored out of sight (i.e., in a drawer or filing cabinet). Any sensitive documents unattended for extended periods or at the end of the workday must be securely locked away.

[2]

4.3. Non-electronic confidential and sensitive information should not be sent to unsecured printers or fax machines and must be promptly removed if inadvertently printed.

[2]

4.4. Non-electronic confidential and sensitive information shall be shredded in official shredder bins or placed in a locked disposal bin for proper discarding.

[2]

4.5. Whiteboards containing sensitive information shall be erased or secured from view when not actively being used.

[7], [8], [9], [10], [11], [3]

4.6. If stored in a filing cabinet, the cabinet must be secure and keys protected and never left unattended.
[2]

4.7. Mass storage devices (i.e. loose hard drives, CDROMs, DVDs, or USB drives) must be secured, when unoccupied and at the end of the workday.
[2], [12]

Applicable State Policies, Federal, State or Industry Rules, Laws, and/or Regulations

1. National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) SP 800-100
2. National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) SP 800-53, Rev 5
3. ISO/IEC 27001
4. WyIT.3013, Physical and Environmental Protection
5. FBI Criminal Justice Information Services (CJIS) Security Policy
6. Federal Information Security Management Act [FISMA], 44 U.S.C. § 3544
7. Privacy Act of 1974, 5 U.S.C. § 552a;
8. Health Insurance Privacy and Accountability Act (HIPAA), Security Rule
9. Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA), 20 U.S.C. 1232g
10. Gramm-Leach-Bliley Act (GLBA), 15 U.S.C. §§ 6801–6809
11. E-Government Act of 2002, § 208
12. WyIT.3015, Physical Media
13. WyIT 2001, Information Classification
14. WyIT 2001-S1, Data Owner Standard
15. WyIT 2001-S2, Data Steward Standard
16. WyIT 2001-S3, Data Custodian Standard
17. WyIT 2001-S4, Data Domain Standard
18. WyIT 2001-G1, Information Classification Guide
19. WyIT 2001-G2, Information Classification Procedures Guide
20. WyIT 3001, General Security - Acceptable Use
21. WyIT 3013, Physical and Environmental Protection
22. Wyoming Public Records Act - W.S. §16-4-201 et seq.

Compliance & Exceptions:

Compliance

Employees who violate this policy may be subject to appropriate disciplinary action up to and including discharge as well as both civil and criminal penalties. Non-employees, including, without limitation, contractors, may be subject to termination of contractual agreements, denial of access to IT resources, and other actions as well as both civil and criminal penalties.

Exceptions

Requests for exceptions to this policy shall be reviewed by the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) and the Chief Information Officer (CIO). Departments requesting exceptions shall provide such requests to the CIO in accordance with WyIT.3002 Policy Exception Request.

The request should specifically state the scope of the exception along with justification for granting the exception, the potential impact or risk attendant upon granting the exception, risk mitigation measures to be undertaken by the IT Department, initiatives, actions and a time-frame for achieving the minimum compliance level with the policies set forth herein. The CIO shall review such requests; confer with the requesting department.

Any exception to established policy shall be defined and tracked as a risk to the state and established mitigating controls monitored by the agency.

Review/Approval:

Date Issued/Review Date

This policy shall be reviewed at least annually and updated / reviewed / approved as defined in the Office of Chief Information Officer (OCIO) Policy lifecycle.

The review and update process shall be coordinated by Governance, Risk and Compliance (GRC), completed by the policy owner and approved through the OCIO policy review workflow.

Approval

This policy as signed by the appropriate officer (listed below) is considered approved and enforced, per Wyoming State Statutes (W.S 9-2-2906,(b), (iii)) and (W.S. 9-2-2906,(b), (vi)).

To obtain a signed copy of this document, contact Enterprise Technology Services Governance, Risk and Compliance (ets-ocio-grc@wyo.gov).

Jeffrey Clines Officer Name	Chief Information Officer Officer Title
_____ Officer's Signature	_____ Date

Revision History

The current version of this policy, as identified in the Revision History below, supersedes all previous documents listed below.

Version	Change	Author(s)	Date of Change
2026-09.1	ETS Director signature	GRC	September 2026
2025-09.2	WyIT 2009, "Clean Desk' Confidential Information and Sensitive Materials, Updated Document Template	Pat Potter	September 2025
UKN	WyIT 2009, "Clean Desk' Confidential Information and Sensitive Materials, Originally Published	Wyoming Data Governance Committee	August 2024


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